

Muncie Redevelopment Commission April 16, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZahGDLB9ItA
Publication Date	2026-04-17T02:45:22Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting Summary

Date: April 16, 2026

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the April 16, 2026 meeting of the Muncie Redevelopment Commission to order [00:00:32](#). Note was made that paper copies of the agenda and packet materials distributed at the meeting were from the previous month, while the correct current materials had been distributed via email.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Bishop, Mr. Miller, Mr. Rawlings, Mr. Pribilla, Ms. Wagley, and Mr. Lowe (seated in the audience).
 - **Members Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly designated by a formal title in the spoken transcript, though leading the proceedings.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in the transcript.
- **Approval of Agenda:**

- *Deliberation:* Commissioners noted the discrepancy between the physical packet and the emailed agenda.
- *Action & Vote Disposition:* Motion to approve the current agenda as distributed via email. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote [00:01:39](#).
- **Approval of Previous Meeting Memoranda:**
 - *Deliberation:* Noted that Mr. Lowe was not present at the previous meeting, and an edit was made to reflect his absence.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Motion to approve the previous meeting minutes with Mr. Bishop's correction. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote [00:02:36](#).
- **Approval of Claims:**
 - *Presentation:* Presented by Craig Wright [00:02:47](#), covering a 4-page claim packet sent via email. Highlighted items included the fourth installment for the downtown development partnership investment and a claim for 3D Company regarding Columbus Avenue reconstruction.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Motion to approve claims. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote [00:03:55](#).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:08:45](#) **Resolution 2026-03: Economic Development Agreement (EDA) for "The Point" Mixed-Use Project**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff (MRC staff/director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Jeff presented an agreement for MRC-owned property (held in the name of ECI CDC), often referred to as "The Point" across the street. The transaction involves a \$250,000 land sale and grants the developer access to previously allocated and awarded "ready money" for the site. The project will feature 50 to 60 residential units and 5,000 square feet of commercial space, totaling a \$15 million investment. The agreement mandates vertical construction to start within 6 months of permitting and substantial completion within 24 months, backed by \$5,000-per-month delay penalties for missing either milestone.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this specific item.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve Resolution 2026-03. Passed 5-0 (Roll Call Vote: Mr. Bishop - Yes, Mr. Miller - Yes, Mr. Pribilla - Yes, Mr. Rawlings - Yes, Ms. Wagley - Yes) [00:12:45](#).
- [00:18:24](#) **Facade Grant Applications (Committee Recommendations)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Zane (presented on behalf of the Facade Grant Committee).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Zane presented four committee-recommended facade/curb appeal grant applications totaling \$38,011.16, which would leave \$67,116 and change for the remainder of 2026:

1. **Innovation Connected** (1208 West White River): Exterior repairs, painting, roof repairs, and signage replacement. Total cost ~\$34,500; capped at \$15,000 (curb appeal grant).
 2. **Common Market** (900 West 8th): Installation of an additional fire exit to comply with state fire marshal requirements. Total project cost \$8,050; 50% cap requested at \$4,025 (board members discussed interior tear-out costs, but maintained the committee's recommended scope based on exterior quotes).
 3. **Sadie Hannah** (913 West Kilgore): Foundation tuck pointing, siding, front door replacement, and exterior painting. Total cost \$9,406; 50% cap at \$4,703.
 4. **Ty Morton** (1201 North Granville): Window frame restoration, gutters, soffit, stoop, foundation, and portico rails. Lowest qualified quote \$28,566.33; 50% cap at \$14,283.16.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve all four grant applications in a single motion. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote [00:26:16](#).
- [00:29:52](#) **Tax Certificate Acquisition & Assignment for Center Township Trustee**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kay Walker, Center Township Trustee.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Trustee Walker requested that the MRC accept the tax sale certificate for 117 North Ohio Street from the County Commissioners (as townships cannot directly receive them) and immediately assign the certificate to Center Township. The property, alongside an adjacent parcel at 113 North Ohio Street, is intended for constructing a storage garage for the township's office and shelter. Legal counsel Ben Freeman confirmed the prospective mechanism, provided the township covers all acquisition and legal costs at no expense to the MRC.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to prospectively accept the tax certificate from the commissioners and assign it to Center Township, with the condition of no expense to the MRC. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote [00:33:04](#).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:41:27](#) **Bill Inman** (McKinley Neighborhood Resident)
 - Spoke on behalf of neighbors expressing concern over lots sold for \$1 each to an out-of-town construction company. Acknowledged the administration's fiscal successes under Mayor Ridenour, but questioned the transparency and terms of the lot sales compared to local residents paying \$7,000+ for comparable lots. Requested more detailed reasoning, quality/resale standards, and neighborhood involvement in future design decisions.

- **00:43:38 Arthur FC Tucker**
 - Promoted a 75,000-square-foot commercial property on Superior Drive. Criticized the board regarding a rejected property offer, a lack of public notice for the meeting, the distribution of last month's agenda copies, and the use of out-of-town developers on municipal projects without adequate public disclosure.
 - **00:47:31 John Chambless** (Crew Properties)
 - Clarified that he is not opposed to out-of-town developers, but emphasized the need for competition and thorough planning. Explained that Crew Properties submitted contingency-based offers on multiple parcels because they were tied together for a planned multi-use development that required off-street parking. Urged the commission to engage in careful, long-term planning before selling property.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **City Report / Jeff's Updates:** Mall agreements are complete and executed, with exterior demolition beginning soon. The downtown gateway sign is installed and operational. Groundbreaking for the Morrison and Jackson subdivision (126 homes) occurs next week. The renovated Muncie Inn (Bliss Point Inn) is nearing completion.
 - **Land Bank Update:** Total property inventory stands at 69, with 7 tax certificates waiting to mature in October. Habitat for Humanity closing on Pershing properties is scheduled, alongside discussions for 10 new properties in the Industry neighborhood. A strategic planning RFP process is underway, and multiple Ball State interns (VISTA, architecture, humanities, urban planning) are joining for the summer.
 - **First Friday Presentation:** Upcoming May 1st presentation by Colby Gray on Muncie's quality of place and infrastructure growth patterns.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned **01:02:32** by the presiding officer until the next regular meeting in May.
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